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RETURN

IOM & URC 2026: Structured Framework for Diaspora Re-Engagement

IOM presented takeaways from the Ukraine Recovery Conference 2026 on engaging diaspora and supporting voluntary return. The discussion emphasized protection, reintegration support, and multi-stakeholder coordination as prerequisites for sustainable return rather than one-off relocation assistance.

3R: Directly actionable for Return pillar: IOM's framework provides a replicable coordination model for government and NGO actors designing diaspora reactivation programs at scale for 2026–2027.

UKRAINE.IOM.INT

1.5–2 Million Young Ukrainians Abroad: Scale of the Return Challenge

Razom for Ukraine highlights that between 1.5 and 2 million young Ukrainians are currently living abroad due to the war. Thirty young leaders from across the EU, Switzerland, and the US participated in URC 2026, signaling civil society pressure to translate youth diaspora engagement into policy commitments.

3R: Quantifies the Return pipeline: the 1.5–2M youth cohort represents Ukraine's highest-value human capital at risk; their engagement at URC 2026 creates a political moment for institutionalizing return incentives.

FACEBOOK.COM / RAZOM FOR UKRAINE

Ukraine Recovery Risks Leaving Millions Behind: IDP and Returnee Absorption Gap

NRC/ReliefWeb reports 3.42 million IDPs and 4.2 million returnees inside Ukraine as of May 2026. Recovery programs are not adequately addressing the needs of this population, risking a two-tier recovery that excludes the most vulnerable and undermines the social contract needed to encourage further voluntary return.

3R: Critical Return risk signal: failure to integrate existing returnees reduces the credibility of return messaging for the diaspora abroad; NRC's findings should inform return program design.

RELIEFWEB.INT / NRC

RECRUIT

ILO Local Employment Partnerships: Demand-Driven Reskilling at Community Level

ILO's LEP approach directly connects employer skills needs with training delivery, enabling upskilling and reskilling aligned to actual labor market demand. The model is being scaled across Ukrainian communities, addressing critical skill gaps in a fragmented post-war labor market.

3R: Core Recruit tool: LEPs operationalize the skills-gap filling function by anchoring training to employer demand, making them the primary scalable infrastructure for workforce recruitment into recovery sectors.

ILO.ORG

LEP4WORK: Kyiv Oblast Pilot Demonstrates Localized Skill-Gap Resolution

The LEP4WORK program establishes Local Employment Partnerships across three key communities in Kyiv oblast, providing a concrete pilot model for translating national labor policy into community-level action. The program targets skills shortages and links employers, training providers, and job seekers within defined geographic clusters.

3R: Recruit evidence base: LEP4WORK's Kyiv oblast results will serve as the replication template for national rollout; early indicators of employer uptake and placement rates are critical metrics to monitor.

ILO.ORG

ILO LEP PDF Brief: Addressing Labour Market Challenges Through Partnerships

The ILO's detailed brief on LEPs outlines the full methodology: demand signals from employers drive curriculum design, municipalities coordinate delivery, and outcomes are measured against employment placements. The approach is explicitly designed for post-crisis labor markets with structural skill mismatches.

3R: Operational Recruit blueprint: provides the technical architecture for scaling skill-gap recruitment programs; relevant for ministries, reconstruction firms, and international partners designing workforce pipelines.

ILO.ORG

Women's Economic Integration: From Inactivity to Productivity

VoxUkraine research demonstrates that providing retraining and employment opportunities to unemployed and economically inactive Ukrainian women yields significant macroeconomic gains. Given the wartime demographic shift that has made women a larger share of the domestic workforce, their systematic integration is now a structural recruitment imperative.

3R: High-impact Recruit opportunity: women represent the largest untapped domestic labor reserve; VoxUkraine's economic modeling provides the business case for investing in female workforce activation programs.

VOXUKRAINE.ORG

RETAIN

Atlantic Council CEO Dialogue 2026: Human Capital as a Corporate Recovery Priority

The Atlantic Council's 2026 CEO Dialogue perspectives highlight human capital development and healthcare as central themes for business leaders engaged in Ukraine's recovery. Corporate investment in human capital retention—through competitive compensation, career pathways, and healthcare—is positioned as a prerequisite for sustainable economic reconstruction.

3R: Strategic Retain signal: CEO-level recognition that talent retention is a business-critical issue elevates brain drain prevention from an HR concern to a board-level and investment-climate issue.

ATLANTICCOUNCIL.ORG

Media as Part of Recovery: Rubryka and Recovery Window at URC 2026

Rubryka's chief Anastasiia Rudenko presented at URC 2026 on the role of media in Ukraine's recovery, framing independent journalism and information ecosystems as components of the human capital retention environment. A functioning, trust-building media landscape reduces emigration push factors by countering misinformation and communicating recovery progress.

3R: Soft Retain infrastructure: media credibility and information quality affect perceived safety and opportunity signals that drive retention decisions; investing in independent media is an indirect human capital retention lever.

RUBRYKA.COM

GLOBAL CONTEXT

Ukrainian Immigrant Population in the US: Migration Policy Institute Tracking

MPI's Jeanne Batalova tracks the significant growth of the Ukrainian immigrant population in the US following Russia's 2022 invasion. This data provides the demographic baseline for the North American segment of the Ukrainian diaspora, informing targeted return and engagement strategies for the US cohort specifically.

3R: Global context for Return/Retain: quantifying the US diaspora segment enables geographically differentiated engagement strategies; the US cohort has distinct legal status pathways and economic profiles versus EU-based Ukrainians.

MIGRATIONPOLICY.ORG
